

Xolace

Xolace Inc.

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A note from the founder

Xolace

The team's foundation doc: what Xolace is, why it exists, and how it works. Status tags — `Shipped` · `Building` · `Planned` — mark what exists in the app today versus what we intend.

1. What Xolace is

| Skincare for your mind.

Xolace helps people reflect on what they're feeling in the moment, so they get clarity on it, understand what's underneath it, and catch what's compounding — so that real support can work.

Real support means two things, in order:

1. **Support inside Xolace** — a curated set of support tools (Kindlings) that our AI routes people to after they reflect, or that they open themselves.
 2. **Support beyond Xolace** — a trusted person in their life, or clinical care, when that is what's actually needed. Xolace's job there is to get them to it sooner, not to stand in for it.
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2. The problem

Most of what weighs on people never gets a name, so it never gets dealt with.

And it doesn't stay small. It stacks: one hard week on another, one unspoken thing under the next. We call this **compounding**. By the time it's big enough to have a name, it's often big enough to need a professional — and the queue for that is long.

Nobody is meeting people in the daily, early moment — before it has a name — with support that's actually safe.

WHO IT'S FOR

Working hypothesis — replace after research.

19–32, at university or early in their career. Functioning by every outside measure — going to class, going to work, replying to the group chat — but carrying more than they show. They'd never call it a mental health problem. When it peaks, usually late at night, they scroll, or type it into ChatGPT.

They don't need a diagnosis. They need to know what this is, catch it before it stacks, and have something real to do about it.

We start in Ghana because we build there. The persona is written to travel to the global English-speaking market, which is our likely real target.

In one line: young adults who are functioning but stretched, would never call it a mental health problem, and currently vent to ChatGPT at 1am.

WHAT PEOPLE USE TODAY

Working hypothesis — named products need verifying in research.

	What they get right	Where they stop
General-purpose AI (ChatGPT and similar) — <i>the one to beat</i>	Always there, free, actually understands what you write	Support is unbounded and unvetted, it leads nowhere, and it has no memory of your patterns built for this
AI journaling and mood apps (e.g. Rosebud, Stoic, How We Feel, Daylio)	Own the daily habit; good at reflection and tracking	Reflection is where it ends — no support once you've named the feeling
Meditation and wellness (e.g. Calm, Headspace)	Deep, polished, trusted support libraries	Support without understanding — you pick a session blind, whatever you're feeling
AI therapy-lite (e.g. Wysa, Woebot)	Structured exercises, with safety taken seriously	Clinical in feel, built around exercises rather than daily life, and asks you to see yourself as having a problem
Therapy	The real thing when it's needed	Scarce, expensive, stigmatised, and not there in the moment
Friends and family	Being known and chosen by someone	Hard to reach for when you can't say what's wrong, and you don't want to be a burden
Social media	Proof that others feel it too	Performance, not safety

Each one does half the job. Journaling apps and general AI **understand**; meditation and therapy-lite apps **support**. Nobody does both, daily, with support drawn from a sandbox built to be safe.

In one line: people handle this today with ChatGPT, journaling apps, or Calm. ChatGPT understands but its support is unbounded and goes nowhere; journaling apps reflect and stop; meditation apps support without understanding. Xolace is the only one that does both, daily, with support from a sandbox we built and vetted.

3. When Xolace wins

The usual answer to the mental health crisis is to move the queue faster: more therapists, quicker triage, shorter waitlists. That matters, but a queue that keeps refilling never empties.

We work the other end. **When Xolace wins, fewer people ever reach the queue**, because what they were carrying got caught while it was still small. A shorter queue is a by-product. People who never needed to join it is the point.

This is a conviction, and also a bet we have to prove. Early evidence points our way (see [upstream prevention evidence](#)), and our own in-app data will have to back it.

One guardrail sits under it, and it doesn't bend:

Fewer people needing care is a win. People who need care and don't get it is a failure — however good our other numbers look.

When someone needs more than Xolace, our job is to get them there sooner, not to hold on to them.

4. Vision and mission

VISION

Mental health care becomes as ordinary as skincare.

Nobody waits for their skin to get bad before they look after it. It's a small daily routine, done whether or not anything is wrong. We want caring for your mind to work the same way: a few minutes, most days, part of normal life.

Two habits make that real:

1. **Daily maintenance** — checking in when nothing is wrong. This is the destination.
2. **Reaching early** — opening Xolace the moment something feels slightly off, not once it's grown. This is usually how people start.

MISSION

Draft — for review. Help people understand and look after their minds every day, so what they carry is caught while it's small.

THE LONG HORIZON

Over 10–20 years, Xolace becomes the **front door to mental health**: the first place people go when something is off, and a continuous thread from there to whatever they need, from a daily check-in through support tools and people who understand, all the way to clinical care. Most companies build one step of that staircase. We intend to build the whole staircase, one phase at a time (see §10).

5. What we believe

AI CARRIES MOST OF THE LOAD. HUMANS GIVE WHAT IT CAN'T.

We think of it as **80/20**. It's an ideal to steer by, not a ratio we measure.

The 80% is the AI. It's there at 3am, never tired, never judging, never makes anyone feel like a burden. It helps people find words when they have none, and notices patterns across weeks that are invisible day to day. It does this for millions of people at once.

The 20% is people. Some things no AI can give, however good it gets:

- being chosen by someone who had no obligation to choose you
- hearing from someone who went through it and came out the other side
- proof that you aren't uniquely, privately broken

That last one sits under a lot of what people carry: not "I feel bad", but "I feel bad in a way that makes me different from everyone else". Only another person can break that.

The 20% is small in volume and large in weight. Inside Xolace it lives in the human Kindlings: Xolacers, peer reflections, and Trusted Bridge (§6).

AI PREPARES PEOPLE FOR EACH OTHER

A lot of what stops people reaching another human is friction: no words for it, fear of judgment, shame, not knowing who to go to. AI is very good at removing that friction. So beyond helping people on its own, a core job of the AI is to make human connection easier to reach: you walk into a conversation already knowing what you want to say.

THE CAMPFIRE

The campfire is our metaphor and our brand style.

You sit by the fire on your own. Its light helps you see what you're carrying. Now and then you hear quiet voices from others in the dark, strangers who feel what you feel.

The fire is the AI. It lights things up and keeps you warm, but it isn't the one you're there to meet. The product's layers take their names from this: **the Fire, Kindlings, the Hearth** (§6).

PEOPLE SHOULD COME BACK BECAUSE IT HELPS

Skincare only works if it's daily, so retention matters to us, and habit mechanics (streaks, milestones, progress) are welcome.

The Fire is not a character. It's closer to a very capable journal that remembers you. We don't rule out persona or companion-style features in future. If they come, they follow the same rules as everything else (§6, §13).

6. The support sandbox

From the outside, Xolace can look like a lot of features: breathing exercises, audio, a library, peer chat, message drafting, voice venting. They aren't scattered. Together they are one thing: **the support layer our AI routes people to.**

WHY WE BUILD THE SUPPORT OURSELVES

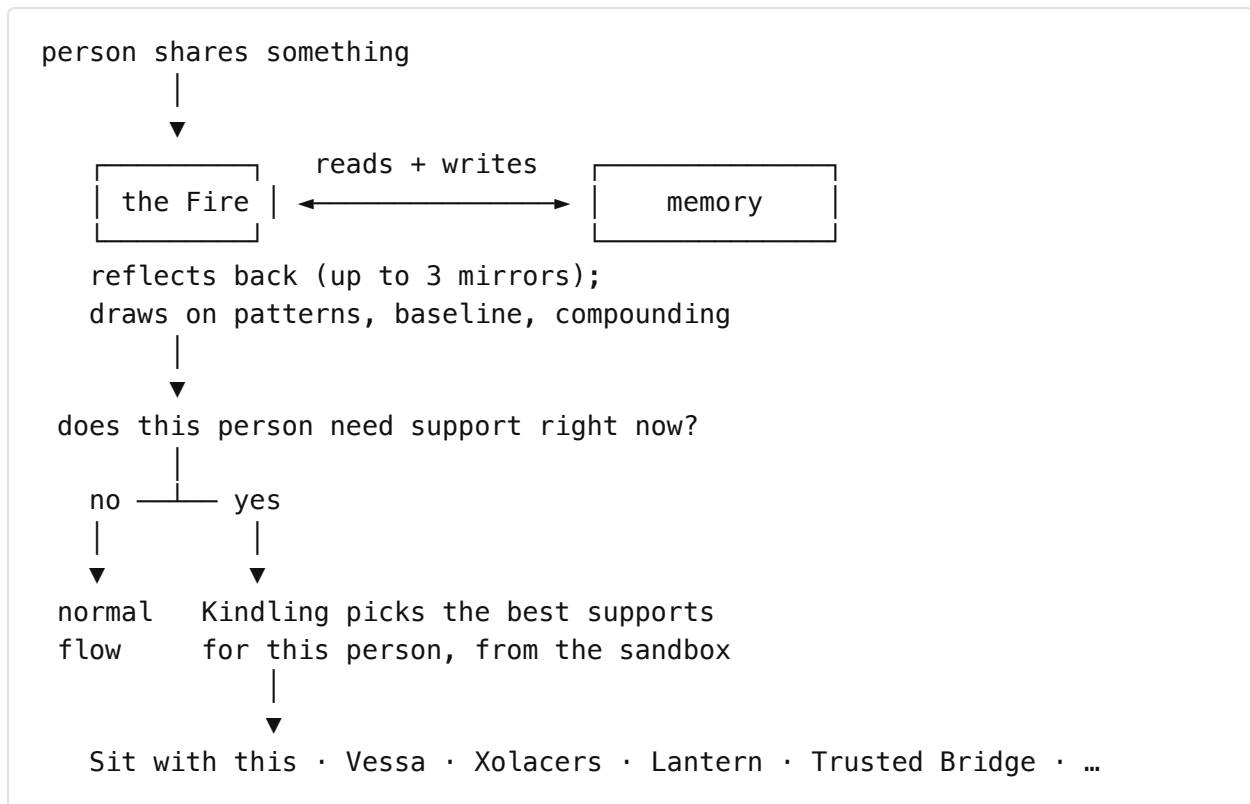
AI isn't deterministic. If we let it invent support for someone in distress, every suggestion is a new, unreviewed piece of advice, and some will be wrong in ways that matter. And when support is just text ("try journaling", "call a friend"), it sends the person out of the

app with nothing to actually do.

So we build the support layer ourselves, and the AI chooses from it. That gives us three things:

1. **Safety.** Every piece of support someone receives is something we built, reviewed and moderated.
2. **Predictability.** The AI's job narrows from *inventing* support to *choosing* it, which is far easier to test and trust.
3. **Room to grow.** Every new Kindling makes the whole system more useful. There's always a next support tool to build or improve.

HOW IT FLOWS



If the Fire detects real risk, Kindling stands down and safety takes over (§9).

THREE LAYERS

Every feature lives in exactly one layer.

Layer	What it does	Includes
The Fire	Reflect, understand, remember	The mirror and its refinements, the understanding of each session, memory across sessions
Kindlings	Support	Everything in the catalogue below
The Hearth	Bring people back daily	Streaks, daily quotes, timeline, campfire card, insights, steadiness

TWO WAYS IN

The sandbox is one shelf with two doors:

- **Routed:** after a reflection, Kindling picks the supports that fit this person and this moment, and says why.
- **Browsed:** people open any Kindling themselves from the app's tabs.

Both doors lead to the same items, held to the same standard.

THE RULES

Support comes from the sandbox. By default the mirror reflects; it doesn't prescribe. If we add a suggestion-style tone, light free-form nudges may be allowed where our safety coverage supports them. Most suggestions will still point to a Kindling.

What makes something a Kindling. Before an item joins the sandbox it must be:

- **in-app:** the person can do it here, now
- **human-reviewed** before it ships
- **tagged** with the emotional states it is and isn't suitable for
- **trackable:** it reports whether it was started and finished, so Kindling learns what helps

Sign-off is the founder's for now. We have no clinical reviewer yet (§9).

THE CATALOGUE

Kindling	What it is	Routed	Browsed	Status
Sit with this	A short guided exercise (e.g. breathing) to stay with a feeling rather than push it away	Yes	After a reflection	Shipped
Vessa	Audio and music by topic	Yes	Yes	Shipped . The name isn't in the app UI yet
Xolacers	Chat with trained volunteer peer counsellors	Yes	Yes	Shipped
Lantern	A library of things to read	Yes	Yes	Shipped
Trusted Bridge	Help drafting a message to someone in your life, so you can reach out	Yes	No (routed only)	Shipped
Episode reframe	Revisit a past reflection with fresh eyes	Yes	—	Shipped . <i>Description to confirm</i>
Peer reflections	Read anonymous reflections from people who felt something similar	Not via Kindling	After a reflection	Shipped
Vent	Say it out loud and let it go. Nothing you say is kept	Not yet	Yes	Shipped (browsed) · Planned (routed)
Clinical care	A route to licensed professionals	—	—	Planned (\$10)

Routed Kindlings are part of Xolace Plus (\$11).

THE FEATURE TEST

Every new feature answers two questions:

1. **Is it worth building?** Does it help someone catch what they're carrying earlier, or make caring for their mind more daily?
 2. **Is it built right?** Does it live in exactly one layer, and if it offers support, is that support inside the sandbox?
-

7. The product today

What a person actually experiences in the app as of October 2026.

THE JOURNEY

1. First open. A short intro, then sign-in. New users go through **intake**: a founder letter, then an 11-question questionnaire in three parts, including a step on what might be compounding for them. Intake ends with the Xolace Plus offer (annual plan, 7-day free trial). Intake answers shape only the first mirror a person sees.

2. Reflect. The home screen *is* the mirror. People start a reflection by typing freely, choosing a guided prompt, doing a body scan, picking from a word cloud, or speaking. They can also reflect again on a past entry.

3. The Fire responds. Xolace writes a short **mirror**: what it hears underneath what the person said. If it's off, they can say *"Not quite"* or *"Say more"*, up to two refinements (three mirrors at most). Then they confirm it landed, or close.

4. After the mirror. The person chooses what to do with it: **sit with this** (a short exercise), **see peer reflections** (others who felt something similar), or **close**.

5. Kindling. If the session suggests the person could use support, Kindling builds their set of supports for the day (one set per day) and announces it. For free users, this moment is an invitation to Plus.

6. Between sessions. A **follow-up check-in** arrives later, sooner after a heavier session. Streaks update, and notifications bring people back gently (never more than one of each kind per day).

WHERE THINGS LIVE

Home (Reflect). The mirror, plus whatever is timely: a welcome-back after time away, a pending check-in, a monthly awareness moment, starter suggestions for new users, a streak celebration. A side menu opens Vent and Settings.

Discovery tab. The campfire card (how many others felt what you felt this week), today's Kindlings, the daily quote, a Lantern shelf, and the person's recent timeline.

Browse tab. Vessa (audio and music by topic) and Lantern (the library).

Connect tab. Xolacers and chats, plus the Xolace channel (updates from the founders).

EVERY SURFACE, BY LAYER

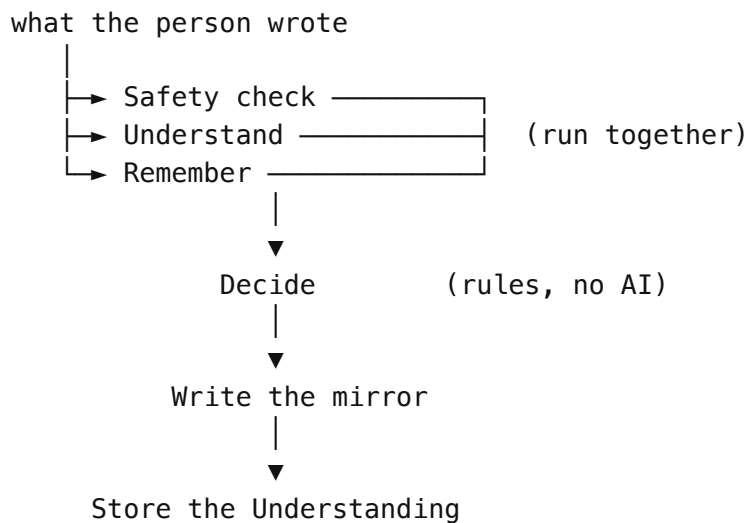
Layer	Surface	Status
The Fire	Mirror with up to two refinements	Shipped
	Five ways to start (free text, guided, body scan, word cloud, voice)	Shipped
	Mirror read aloud	Shipped
	Tone settings for the mirror	Shipped
	Memory across sessions	Shipped
Kindlings	See the catalogue (§6)	—
The Hearth	Streaks, with freezes and revives	Shipped
	Daily quotes, with replies and an archive	Shipped
	Timeline of past reflections	Shipped
	Campfire card	Shipped
	Follow-up check-ins	Shipped
	Monthly awareness moments	Shipped
	Notifications (check-ins, Kindling ready, streaks, gentle return)	Shipped
	Xolace channel	Shipped
	Insights	Building . Profile shows previews only
	Steadiness and compounding (score, baseline, what's stacking)	Building
Safety	Crisis resources	Shipped (§9)

What's free and what's Plus is in §11.

8. How the AI works

Concepts only. Models, providers and code live in `xolace-technical.md`.

ONE REFLECTION, STEP BY STEP



1. **Safety check.** Every input is screened before anything else: a rules engine plus an outside moderation service. It assigns a level: *none*, *gentle*, *elevated*, *crisis*. At crisis, the person is shown crisis resources rather than a normal session. Stories about surviving something hard are recognised and not mistaken for live risk.
2. **Understand.** An AI reads the input and names what's there: the emotions, how intense, how specific, the themes, and **how much support the person seems to need** (*none*, *light*, *active*).
3. **Remember.** The person's past sessions are searched for moments that resemble this one (skipped on a first session).
4. **Decide.** Plain rules, not AI, use all of the above to set the mirror's tone, **how confidently it should speak** (from tentative to sure, depending on how clear the input is and how strongly the past matches), whether to raise a safety flag, and when to check in later.
5. **Write the mirror.** An AI writes the mirror within those settings. If it fails, the person sees a safe fallback rather than an error.

6. **Store the Understanding.** Everything learned about the session is saved as one record: what was felt, the safety verdict, the support need, and which memories informed the mirror.

REFINEMENTS

When the person says *"Not quite"* or *"Say more"*, their new words go through the safety check again, memory is searched again, and the mirror is rewritten. After the second refinement, the mirror stops claiming and simply holds what's there. When the person confirms a mirror, the memories that helped are weighted up for next time.

AFTER THE SESSION

- **Memory** saves the session so future mirrors can draw on it. Crisis sessions are saved without their content, and sessions the person chose not to keep are never saved.
- **The person's profile** (their recurring themes, emotional patterns and direction over time) gets a light refresh after every session. A deeper rewrite happens after five sessions or a week of activity. Only this background process can change the profile.
- **Peer reflections:** if the person chose to share, an anonymised version is written for the peer pool.
- **Kindling** runs if the conditions below are met.
- **A follow-up check-in** is scheduled, sooner after heavier sessions.

HOW KINDLING CHOOSES

Kindling runs only when **all** of these are true:

- the session suggests a light or active need for support
- the safety level is below *elevated* (above that, safety takes over)
- the person is on Plus
- they haven't had a set today

One AI call picks four items **from the sandbox catalogue only** and writes a one-line *why* for each. If fewer than three valid items come back, nothing is shown. An empty set is better than a bad one.

OTHER PLACES AI IS USED

Drafting Trusted Bridge messages · writing follow-up check-in cards · personalising notification wording · session-based quotes · Vent's spoken response · moderating Xolacer chats. Each one is a small, single-purpose call.

THE RULE THAT KEEPS IT COHERENT

Nothing asks the AI to work out something the Understanding already knows.

Every feature reads the stored Understanding and memory rather than re-analysing the person. A new AI call is justified only for genuinely new input (like voice) or a genuinely new output (like a Bridge draft).

9. Safety and privacy

People bring Xolace the things they don't say anywhere else. The sandbox only means something if everything around it is just as careful. This section sets the standard, then lists honestly where we fall short today.

SAFETY: WHAT'S IN PLACE

- **Every input is screened** before the AI responds (§8). Levels run *none* → *gentle* → *elevated* → *crisis*.
- **At crisis**, the person is shown crisis resources: Ghana's Mental Health Authority line (0800 678 678), emergency services (112), DOVVSU (18555), the IASP directory, and our support email. The event is recorded.
- **At elevated or crisis**, Kindling stands down. No support suggestions are made when safety should lead.
- **Peer reflections** only enter the shared pool if the person chose to share, kept the session, and it wasn't a crisis session. A reflection is hidden automatically once three different people report it.
- **Xolacer chats** are checked by AI for harassment, spam and sharing contact details, which get flagged. If a message signals crisis, a support card is posted into the chat. We store only the verdict, not the message.

- **Xolacers** are trained by a partner organisation and can't sign themselves up. Only an operator can make someone a Xolacer.
- **Vent** has its own crisis check.

PRIVACY: WHAT WE PROMISE

1. **Your reflections are private by default.** No one else sees them.
2. **Nothing containing your words reaches anyone else without your consent.**
3. **You can delete everything.**
4. **Vent is never stored.**
5. **We don't train AI on your words.**

The consent line: anonymous counts across many people, with a minimum group size (like the campfire card's "others felt this too", never fewer than three), don't need consent. Anything containing a person's words does.

Retention: by default we keep a person's history so the Fire can remember them. They can choose to auto-delete after 6 months or a year.

KNOWN GAPS

These are where today's product falls short of the standard above. Each needs an owner and a date (§10).

#	Gap	Why it matters
1	Escalation alerts no one. Crisis events are recorded, but no person is notified.	Someone at real risk depends entirely on the resources screen.
2	Crisis resources are Ghana-only.	Wrong or useless numbers for anyone outside Ghana, which our target market mostly is.
3	No clinical reviewer. Kindlings and the mirror's behaviour are reviewed by the founder only.	Our safety claim rests on review, and that review isn't clinical.
4	Xolacer training isn't recorded in the app.	"Trained" depends on whoever promotes the account. Nothing checks it.
5	Chat moderation runs after delivery.	A harmful message is seen before it's flagged.
6	Peer pool can fall back to the raw mirror. If anonymising fails, the shared text is the person's own mirror.	Identifying details could reach the pool.
7	Shared reflections can't be withdrawn. By design they aren't linked to the author, so nothing can find them later.	Breaks "you can delete everything" for anything shared.
8	Deletion is incomplete. Analytics (PostHog), sign-in (Clerk) and subscription (RevenueCat) records aren't deleted. Chat deletion (Stream) can fail without anyone noticing. Product-feedback text is kept on purpose but not disclosed.	Breaks promise 3.
9	Vent leaves traces. The words Vent says back are written to server logs, and their audio is kept for an hour.	Breaks promise 4 as worded.
10	AI provider retention is unverified. We send text to Anthropic, OpenAI and ElevenLabs. Whether they keep	Promise 5 is true in our code but not guaranteed

#	Gap	Why it matters
	it is an account setting we haven't confirmed.	end to end.

Anything user-facing (store listing, privacy policy, in-app copy) uses only wording that's literally true today. This list is the gap between that wording and the standard we're holding ourselves to.

10. Phases

Big vision, one phase at a time. Each phase has to be valuable on its own, and each one makes the next stronger.

PHASE 1 — REFLECT · SHIPPED

The Fire: people reflect, get a mirror that names what's underneath, and Xolace remembers them across sessions. The Hearth's basics are in place: streaks, quotes, timeline, campfire card, check-ins.

PHASE 2 — THE SUPPORT LAYER · *WE ARE HERE*

The sandbox: Kindling routes people to curated support, and the same Kindlings can be browsed directly.

Done	Next
Kindling routing (Plus)	Steadiness and compounding: a score, a personal baseline, and showing people what's stacking up. This is what makes "catch what's compounding" true.
Six routed Kindlings (§6)	Insights: real views, replacing today's previews
Browse and Connect tabs	Route Vent through Kindling
	Show the Vessa name in the app
	Use Kindling completions to improve future picks
	Grow the catalogue
	Close the safety and privacy gaps (below)

PHASE 3 — PROACTIVE

Xolace stops waiting to be opened. When it sees something compounding, it reaches out first, with a check-in, a nudge, or a Kindling, before the person thinks to ask.

Early pieces already exist: follow-up check-ins after sessions, pattern-based nudges, and gentle return messages after time away.

Meet people where they already are. Skincare sits on the bathroom shelf, not in a separate building. Proactive care shouldn't depend on someone remembering to open an app. Channels that fit, all opt-in:

- **WhatsApp:** follow-up check-ins sent directly, which the person can answer in the thread, including with a voice note. A short reply can become a light reflection, with a link into the app for the full mirror or a Kindling. This matters most in Ghana and other WhatsApp-first markets.
- **SMS:** the same check-in for people on low data or basic phones.
- **Home-screen and lock-screen widgets:** a one-tap check-in ("how's today?") and today's Kindling, without opening the app.

- **Wearables:** a check-in from the watch. With consent, sleep and heart-rate signals could hint that something is stacking up before the person notices.
- **Calendar moments:** the person marks hard dates (exams, anniversaries, a difficult meeting), and Xolace checks in before and after.
- **Voice assistants:** “Hey Siri, check in with Xolace” starts a voice reflection hands-free.
- **Weekly email:** a short look back at the week (what came up, what helped) for people who prefer a slower rhythm.

Two rules come with leaving the app:

1. **Discreet by default.** Phones get seen by others. Messages outside the app never reveal what someone is carrying, only that Xolace is checking in, unless the person chooses otherwise.
2. **The sandbox still holds.** Outside channels check in and listen. Support is still a Kindling, and anything that signals risk goes through the same safety check (§9) and links to crisis resources.

PHASE 4 — CLINICAL

Licensed care becomes the top of the sandbox. When someone needs more than Xolace, we route them to a professional, and with their consent the context they’ve built carries over, so their first session doesn’t start from zero.

CLOSING THE GAPS

The §9 gaps belong to Phase 2. Suggested order, highest risk first:

Priority	Gaps (\$9)	Before	Owner	Date
1	Escalation alerts no one (1), Ghana-only resources (2)	Any growth outside Ghana		
2	No clinical reviewer (3), Xolacer training unrecorded (4)	Adding more Kindlings		
3	Pool falls back to raw mirror (6), Vent traces (9), deletion gaps (8)	The next privacy-policy update		
4	Post-delivery moderation (5), shared reflections can't be withdrawn (7), provider retention (10)	Scale		

11. Business model

The mirror is free, and always will be. The support layer is what Plus pays for.

Understanding what you feel shouldn't depend on whether you can pay. Kindling, the deeper support and the depth over time are where Xolace earns. Running them costs real compute, so we don't give that compute away.

FREE AND PLUS TODAY

	Free	Xolace Plus
The Fire	Reflect and get mirrors, with refinements, within fair-use limits	Higher limits · extra mirror tones and voice
Kindling	An invitation to Plus at the moment support would appear	Daily routed Kindlings, with a <i>why</i> for each
Vessa	Previews	Full audio, with transcripts
Trusted Bridge	—	Message drafts
Peer reflections	Matched by theme	Matched more closely to what you felt
Vent	A few minutes a day	More minutes
Timeline	Last 30 days	Full history
Quotes	The daily quote	Quotes from your own sessions, kept
Insights	Previews	Full insights (Building)
Look and feel	Core themes and avatars	Premium themes and avatars

Lantern and Xolacer chat aren't Plus-gated in the code today. Confirm whether that's intended.

Plus is sold as an annual plan with a 7-day free trial, offered at the end of intake. The price isn't fixed in this doc because it will change. Exact limits are in `xolace-technical.md`.

LATER

- **Organisations** (universities, employers) offering Xolace to their people, once the consumer product has proven itself.
- **Clinical care** (Phase 4), as a revenue line of its own.

NEVER

- **No ads.**
- **No selling or licensing user data**, in any form.

The product only works if people trust it with what they don't say anywhere else. Anything that trades that trust for revenue is off the table.

12. How we measure

NORTH STAR

Weekly active reflectors: people who complete at least one reflection in a given week.

Skincare works because it's regular, so the number that tells us the vision is happening is how many people make Xolace part of their week.

THE COUNTERWEIGHT

Steadiness over time: whether people's steadiness improves across 30 days. ·

Building (tracked in-app once steadiness and compounding ship)

The north star alone could be gamed by compulsion. This one checks that people come back because it's helping. If reflectors rise while steadiness doesn't, something is wrong.

SUPPORTING METRICS, BY LAYER

Layer	Metric	What it tells us
The Fire	Mirror landed rate: share of sessions where the person confirms a mirror	Whether we're actually naming what people feel
	Give-up rate: sessions that hit the refinement limit unconfirmed	Where the Fire is missing
Kindlings	Kindling start and completion rates	Whether routed support gets used
	Human reach: share of weekly reflectors who touch a human Kindling (Xolacers, peer reflections, Trusted Bridge)	Whether the 20% is real
The Hearth	Return within 7 days	Whether the habit is forming
	Check-in response rate	Whether proactive care lands
Business	Free to Plus at the Kindling invitation · trial to paid	Whether the support layer is worth paying for

GUARDRAILS

- **Escalation reaches help.** Every crisis-level session shows crisis resources, and once gap 1 (§9) is closed, a person is alerted.
- **Unhealthy use is watched.** Unusually heavy or late-night-only use is a signal to look at, not a win to celebrate.
- **Fewer referrals is never a goal (§3).** If people who need care stop reaching it, nothing else on this page counts.

NOT GOALS

Time in app. Sessions per user for their own sake. Streak length for its own sake.

13. Open questions

Things we haven't decided yet. Each will be answered by research or a decision, then moved into the right section.

Research

1. **Who exactly is it for?** The persona in §2 is a working hypothesis. Which person, in which situation, gets the most from Xolace?
2. **Who are our real competitors?** The §2 table is a starting point. Which products do our users actually use instead of us?
3. **Which market?** We build in Ghana. Is the global English-speaking market the right target, and in what order do we reach it?

Product

4. **Persona and companion features.** Not ruled out. If they come, how do they fit the sandbox rules (§6)?
5. **Suggestion tone.** If the mirror gets a tone that suggests, which free-form nudges are safe enough to allow?
6. **Peer reflections through Kindling.** Should they become routable like other Kindlings?
7. **Episode reframe.** Confirm what it does and how we describe it (§6).
8. **Free access to Lantern and Xolacer chat.** Intended, or a gap in gating (§11)?
9. **Mission statement.** The §4 mission is a draft.

Operations

10. **Owners and dates** for the safety and privacy gaps (§10).
 11. **Clinical review.** Who reviews Kindlings and the mirror's behaviour, and when do we add them?
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14. Glossary

Product names are what the team and users say. Code names are what engineers will find in the codebase.

THE LAYERS

Term	Meaning	In code
The Fire	The part of Xolace that reflects, understands and remembers	Classifier, safeguard, articulator, Understanding, memory
Kindlings	The support layer: the curated set of support tools	The catalogue of path/twig types
The Hearth	Everything that brings people back daily	Streaks, daily quotes, timeline, cohort card, follow-ups, notifications

THE FIRE

Term	Meaning	In code
Reflection / session	One time someone shares and gets a mirror	<code>sessions</code>
Mirror	The short reflection Xolace writes back	Articulator output
Refinement	"Not quite" / "Say more": rewriting the mirror (two at most)	<code>sessionTurns</code>
Landed	The person confirms a mirror is right	<code>confirmMirror</code> (confirmed)
Safety level	<i>none, gentle, elevated, crisis</i>	Safeguard level
Support need	<i>none, light, active</i> : how much support a session suggests	<code>supportNeed</code>
Claim strength	How confidently the mirror speaks	<code>claimStrength</code>
Understanding	Everything learned about one session, stored once and read by every feature	<code>emotional_metadata</code> , read via <code>understanding.getUnderstanding</code>
Memory	Past sessions the Fire can search for similar moments	Episodic memory (RAG)
Profile	A person's recurring themes, patterns and direction over time	<code>semantic_profiles</code> , written by the Reflection Agent

KINDLINGS

Term	Meaning	In code
Kindling	The AI step that picks a person's supports for the day, and the set it produces	Paths (<code>ai/paths</code> , <code>features/kindling</code>)
Twig	One support item in the sandbox	A twig / path step
Sit with this	Short guided exercise	<code>sit-with-this</code> , <code>breathing</code>
Vessa	Audio and music by topic	Browse audio, <code>audio_topic_*</code> , <code>music_topic_*</code>
Lantern	The reading library	<code>library</code>
Xolacers	Trained volunteer peer counsellors, and chatting with them	<code>xolacer</code> , Stream chat
Trusted Bridge	Help drafting a message to someone in your life	<code>bridge</code>
Episode reframe	Revisiting a past reflection	<code>episode_reframe</code>
Peer reflections	Anonymous reflections shared by others	<code>reflections</code> , the peer pool
Vent	Voice release; nothing is kept	<code>vent</code> , <code>voice-vent</code>

THE HEARTH AND THE REST

Term	Meaning	In code
Campfire card	How many others felt what you felt this week	Cohort card
Follow-up check-in	A check-in after a session, timed by how heavy it was	<code>followUps</code>
Xolace channel	Updates from the founders	<code>xolace-channel</code> (Stream)
Intake	First-run letter and questionnaire	<code>(intake)</code>
Xolace Plus	The paid plan	Entitlement <code>xolace-plus</code>
Compounding	Small unaddressed things stacking into something bigger over time	Not yet in code
Steadiness	A measure of how steady someone is over time, against their own baseline	Not yet in code

A note from the founder

If you've read this far: thank you.

From the outside, this can look like a lot of features. It isn't. It's one idea: help people look after their minds the way they look after their skin, a little every day and before anything goes wrong, and when they need support, make sure what they reach for is something we built carefully enough to trust.

"Own the whole staircase, up to clinical care" is a big sentence for a small team. Good. We earn it one phase at a time, and the phase we're in is the one that matters.

Build the next Kindling well. Close the next gap. Let's go.